

## Chapter 5

Xu Qingzhu's condition onset so quickly that the ward soon descended into chaos.

Zhao Xuning kept talking to Xu Qingzhu, trying to comfort her emotions.

But at this moment, Xu Qingzhu couldn't listen to anything. Her hands tightly gripped the blanket, her knuckles turning white. After the initial piercing screams, she buried her head in her knees, her whole body trembling non-stop.

"Xu Qingzhu, listen to me. This is a hospital, no one will hurt you." Zhao Xuning spoke to her much more gently than when she spoke to Liang Shi. "It's okay, you can trust me. I'm Zhao Xuning."

Xu Qingzhu suddenly buried herself completely under the blanket, still trembling.

Zhao Xuning turned around, originally wanting to see if Dr. Gu had arrived, but instead saw Liang Shi standing there. She frowned and said impatiently: "Why haven't you left yet?"

Without waiting for Liang Shi's reaction, she instructed the nurse beside her: "Push her out, don't let her affect the patient's mood."

Liang Shi frowned slightly. During the process of the nurses pushing her, her long hair came loose.

The beautiful and imposing Alpha made the nurses unconsciously pause their actions, as if pushing her one more step would make the Alpha angry.

But Liang Shi gently struggled and broke free directly: "I can walk by myself."

If an Alpha really didn't want to leave, no amount of force from Betas would work.

Liang Shi carried the strawberries and walked toward the exit. But when she reached the doorway, she suddenly turned back. She pressed her lips together, her voice very gentle but carrying a stubborn strength.

She called Xu Qingzhu's name softly: "Xu Qingzhu."

The trembling on the bed suddenly stopped. Like a timid cat, Xu Qingzhu tentatively pulled open the blanket, but only looked for a moment before immediately hiding back in the darkness that gave her a sense of security.

"Whether you believe it or not, I will never hurt you." Liang Shi turned around and showed a gentle smile.

Even though Xu Qingzhu couldn't see it, she believed that sincere goodwill could reach the other person.

Liang Shi said: "Don't be afraid. There are many people here who can protect you. When you get better, we'll talk about other things."

"Get out." Zhao Xuning said coldly: "The patient is emotionally unstable right now. Everything can wait until she's better. Don't pressure the patient now."

Liang Shi's expression also turned cold. She looked directly at Zhao Xuning: "This isn't pressuring the patient."

"Then what are you doing right now?!"

Zhao Xuning questioned.

"I'm just making a promise to Xu Qingzhu." When mentioning Xu Qingzhu, Liang Shi's voice immediately became gentle. "I want her not to be afraid."

"Xu Qingzhu." Liang Shi called her gently once more. "I'm leaving now. Listen to the doctor. I did many wrong things in the past, but from now on, I absolutely won't let you be harmed."

After saying this, she walked out, casually handing the strawberries to the nurses and telling them to share them.

Soon, Dr. Gu arrived.

Liang Shi stood in the corridor listening to the sounds from the ward. Before long, the ward became quiet.

She finally breathed a sigh of relief.

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Gu Junru was Xu Qingzhu's dedicated psychiatrist.

She had been treating Xu Qingzhu's post-traumatic stress disorder. The kidnapping incident had happened nearly twenty years ago, but it had a tremendous impact on Xu Qingzhu's personality.

For a very long time, Xu Qingzhu didn't speak at all.

It wasn't until she was ten that Xu Qingzhu spoke again, and by fifteen, her condition had temporarily stabilized.

She hadn't had any episodes for a long time.

Today's incident shocked Gu Junru as well.

Fortunately, the situation wasn't particularly severe. Before she arrived, Xu Qingzhu had already received some comfort.

Gu Junru gave Xu Qingzhu a sedative and cleared everyone out of the ward.

After Xu Qingzhu fell into a deep sleep and completely relaxed, she tucked her in properly, then beckoned to Zhao Xuning: "What happened? Why did she suddenly have an episode?"

Zhao Xuning adjusted her glasses, hands in her white coat pockets, saying irritably: "Who else could it be because of?"

"I just saw Liang Shi at the door." Gu Junru said.

Zhao Xuning spoke with disgust: "No one else but her."

"But..." Gu Junru paused.

Zhao Xuning raised an eyebrow: "What?"

Gu Junru shook her head and remained silent.

This was patient privacy.

"Did Liang Shi comfort Qingzhu just now?" Gu Junru changed the subject.

"Yes." Zhao Xuning said: "Zhuzhu even poked her head out because of what she said."

"What did she say exactly?" Gu Junru's voice was very calm. "It would be best if you could tell me in detail."

Zhao Xuning frowned and coldly repeated Liang Shi's words, then sneered: "Hypocritical."

Gu Junru didn't comment on this matter.

She didn't know much about their married life, but she remembered that when treating Xu Qingzhu years ago, Xu Qingzhu had mentioned that a girl had once given her courage. When they were kidnapped together, that girl was braver than her and encouraged her to be brave.

Then, during the last checkup, Xu Qingzhu said she was getting married.

The marriage partner was that girl.

Zhao Xuning looked at Xu Qingzhu's pale face and sighed helplessly: "It's up to her."

Gu Junru nodded: "She's very brave."

★★

When Xu Qingzhu woke up, it was evening, and the ward was empty.

Zhao Xuning had probably sent everyone away so she could rest well. She had left a note by her pillow telling her to press the emergency bell by the bed or call her when she woke up.

Xu Qingzhu just sat there in a daze.

The events of these two days had exhausted her mentally and physically. She needed a quiet space to clear her mind.

But when she first woke up, her body was dehydrated. She reached for the water cup by the bed, but because her hands lacked strength, she accidentally knocked the cup to the floor, making a crisp sound.

It startled her and made her shiver.

Then the ward door was pushed open, and a nervous-looking Liang Shi ran in: "Are you okay?"

Xu Qingzhu frowned tightly as she stared at her, her hand already on the emergency bell, but suddenly an unopened bottle of water was handed to her.

Liang Shi said gently: "If you need it, I can help you open the cap."

An unopened bottle of water shouldn't be dangerous anymore, right?

"This is warm water." Liang Shi said: "I've been holding it in my hand to warm it."

Xu Qingzhu stared at her motionlessly.

The person in front of her felt strange.

Not quite like the Liang Shi she knew.

Seeing that she wasn't speaking, Liang Shi felt a bit panicked inside but pretended to be calm as she said: "Do you need me to open it for you?"

She was about to withdraw her hand when Xu Qingzhu took the bottle of water and said coldly: "No need."

She held the water, which still retained Liang Shi's body warmth.

There was also a faint tea fragrance, similar to white tea Silver Needle<sup>1</sup>.

That was a type of tea her late grandfather had really liked.

Liang Shi had already taken the ward's broom and dustpan and was bending down to clean up the glass fragments on the floor.

Xu Qingzhu gripped the bottle, watching her unfamiliar movements, and suddenly spoke: "Who are you?"

Liang Shi's movements paused. She looked up and smiled: "I'm Liang Shi."

Xu Qingzhu's frown deepened: "Are you?"

"Yes, we're married." Liang Shi said: "Have you lost your memory?"

When she said this, Liang Shi's eyes showed bewilderment.

Her acting was very good, so she didn't let Xu Qingzhu see through her at this moment.

When she reached out to touch Xu Qingzhu's forehead, Xu Qingzhu dodged backward, avoiding her touch.

Xu Qingzhu didn't speak again.

Liang Shi finished cleaning up the debris on the floor. When she turned back, she saw Xu Qingzhu struggling with the bottle cap.

The sick Omega was weak and powerless. At this moment, she couldn't even open a bottle cap. It was difficult for her to even drink water. Liang Shi walked over in two quick steps, standing there hesitantly and asking: "How about I do it?"

Xu Qingzhu continued trying with her head down. Her pink fingernails had turned pale from exerting too much force.

Liang Shi couldn't bear to watch and directly reached out to take it. Her fingers happened to touch Xu Qingzhu's fingers.

It was clearly a very simple touch, but Xu Qingzhu suddenly looked up.

Liang Shi also belatedly pulled her hand back, but in the moment of withdrawal, Xu Qingzhu's fingers lightly brushed across her palm.

Bringing a tingling, tickling sensation.

Her heart suddenly beat much faster.

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### Footnotes:

<sup>1</sup> White tea Silver Needle (白毫銀針) - A high-quality type of Chinese white tea known for its delicate flavor and silver-white appearance